

# CS4001- Professional Practices in IT

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# Washington Accord

- ▶ The **Washington Accord** is an international accreditation agreement for professional engineering academic degrees, between the bodies responsible for accreditation in its signatory countries

There are three agreements covering mutual recognition in respect of qualifications in engineering:

- ▶ The Washington Accord signed in 1989 was the first - it recognizes substantial equivalence in the accreditation of qualifications in professional engineering, normally of four years duration.
- ▶ The Sydney Accord commenced in 2001 and recognizes substantial equivalence in the accreditation of qualifications in engineering technology, normally of three years duration.
- ▶ The Dublin Accord is an agreement for substantial equivalence in the accreditation of tertiary qualifications in technician engineering, normally of two years duration. It commenced in 2002.

# Professional Bodies in Computing

- ▶ The development of Professional Bodies in Computing
  - ▶ 1946: The Institute of Electrical and Electronic Engineers (IEEE):  
A professional engineering society basically USA based but with members and activities spread worldwide. This was the IEEE Computer Society (IEEE-CS). It has over 100,000 members.
  - ▶ 1947: Association for Computing Machinery (ACM):  
USA based but have members and activities in many countries. It has over 75,000 members
  - ▶ 1957: British Computer Society (BCS):  
UK based society. In mid 1960's it became a qualification awarding society. Then in 2009 it named itself as BCS- The Chartered Institute of IT.
  - ▶ 1871: Institution of Electrical Engineers (IEE):  
It has over 130,000 members.
  - ▶ 1961: Italian Association for Informatics and Automatic Computing
  - ▶ 1965: The Computer Society of India

# Professional Bodies in Computing.....

- ▶ The development of Professional Bodies in Computing cont.....
  - ▶ 1966: Australian Computer Society
  - ▶ 1967: the Singapore Computer Society and the Irish Computer Society
  - ▶ 1969: German Informatics Society
  - ▶ 1976: The Computer Society of Sri Lanka
  - ▶ 1998: The Computer Society of Maritius

# Code of Conduct

- ▶ All the mentioned professional bodies have set a code of conduct that their members need to obey.
- ▶ The BCS's Code of Conduct:  
The Code is divided into the following sections:
  - ▶ The Public Interest
  - ▶ Duty to the Relevant Authority
  - ▶ Duty to the Profession
  - ▶ Professional Competence and Integrity

# The Public Interest

- ▶ Regard public health, privacy, security and wellbeing of public
- ▶ Regard rights of third party
- ▶ conduct your professional activities without personal biasness
- ▶ promote equal access to the benefits of IT

# Duty to the Relevant Authority

- ▶ Avoid conflicts of interest.
- ▶ Avoid misrepresentation
- ▶ Don't pass on confidential information without permission.

# Duty to the Profession

- ▶ Accepting personal duty and avoid actions which can harm the image of the profession
- ▶ seek to improve professional standards through participation in their development, use and enforcement.
- ▶ encourage and support fellow members in their professional development



# Professional Competence and Integrity

- ▶ Only take a job or offer a service that is within your professional competence.
- ▶ Do not claim for any level of competence that you do not possess.
- ▶ Get up to date knowledge in your relevant field.
- ▶ respect and value alternative viewpoints and, seek, accept and offer honest criticisms of work
- ▶ Avoid harming others by false devilish or negligent actions
- ▶ Reject bribery